

renj

rivers running *backwards*

1	foreword
2	untitled (1222)
3	lines of this clock
4	the night train ride
5	for touching is a sin
6	true to word and true to man
7	before us
8	the move of might
9	for that city is ahead
10	acacia flowers are not forever
11	to give a reason

table of contents

foreword

The hands were never made to measure, and still we keep time. These words, like rivers, refused the course I set – ran backwards, against current, against sense, dragging memory and dream and grief along their silt-heavy bends. I did not write them to be read, only to be released. If they return to you like echoes, half-heard and full of ache, then let them be what they are: small declarations, half-truths, stubborn feelings that would not drown.

This is for the thoughts that never formed into breath – unborn, unspoken, unspent. The kind only the stars could ever spell out, but once you blink, the pattern disappears.

This is dedicated to you.

untitled (1222)

renj

Seven moons past my eyes,
Sunset hues over my skies,
Chapters torn with price,
Sandwiched between lies.

The night is wild,
But the heart is mild.
Seven Suns bear child,
With the unkind.

So much syllables trapped
In the hill, light has tapped.
Tell my hands who to wrap,
Tell my eyes when to stop.

The ventilation arrests my soul,
Covering these holes.
Perforated through it all,
Pieces acquired in whole.

renj

lines of this clock

Crimson rose hues over this pale face,
One heart that had remained unfazed.
The clock, its ticking, the only companion,
The mind, rationality – his opposition.

It was not for sanctity nor sanitation,
He crashed for the survival of his ideation.
A scenario is worth more than a real moment,
To ease the scribbles of torment.

Why would they be concerned with this color,
Yet concerned if it was blank and subtle?
I know I have tried, and they all failed,
But they did believe the first time I sailed.

How far has this shattered muscle fallen?
As well as the man that keeps it beating?
For his name is one we do not speak,
Even he cannot take himself for a walk.

Let me resuscitate my dreams in forms of me,
And shade them with the colors I want them to be.
For what had flown is what had been lost,
And what had stayed is what truly cost.

So I'll stay in between the lines of this clock,
If that remains the only way for me to come back.
The only window to a soul long gone,
The only way to go back to where it began.

the night train ride

renj

Shameful during the night train ride,
What happened to the ephemeral tide?
How can the fleeting remain in this mind,
And catch my foresight from behind?
I have waited for this great unshielding,
But man, I never thought I would be this longing.

The waves were brief but patterned over,
A face stricken by the fear to remember.
For the night sky spells out one name,
But one that haunts, killing over my failing fame.
To long for the ripples is a crime in itself,
One cannot understate the needed help.

But to ask is to know what you want,
And to say I need to forget is not right.
When reality is shaped by those waves,
Those that can only be in my mind's rave.
I have ridden the rails for too long tonight,
Well then, tomorrow is for another sight.

renj

for touching is a sin

Dark side over the true fire,
The flames are only deception.
The eyes see what they want to,
But to look at one is dire.
When it arrives at inception,
Then the years come true.

For the skies shall haunt you,
The constellations will spell out.
The yesterday that you resent,
Will always be there behind you.
And those that are great about,
For your mind was never meant.

To replay the end and start again,
Just to see what you find.
For all you do is look and try,
And feel the numbness begin.
You let it set in your mind,
When you touched it, you should've cried.

And tomorrow is just a paradigm,
Looking forward to a routine cry.
Thinking of the past like it's alive,
To think of your heavenly crime.
For what worth did it fly?
For what goal did it strive?

Careful of the eyes that show interest,
For touching is to burn the flesh.
The dinner is served for this night,
But later you are the unrest.
Insurgency would haunt your flesh,
And to think of it ends your fight.

true to word and true to man

renj

A disease had stricken men again,
One that had already been since the world began.
True to word, it was incurable,
And true to man, it became acceptable.
Appreciated were those hit by it,
But when it leaves, those men were devastated.
A brink of explosion comes to those who wish it,
Heated cheeks fly over the flesh breath.
The heart overcomes all the knowledge of biology,
The mind cannot create any more analogy.
The disease comes clearer but, at the same time,
Becomes more blurry, distorted, and messier.
In utter entropy, an unprecedented order appears,
And the fixations turn to habits over the years.
Navy blue shoes, white laces, and black socks –
That was the standard for moving blocks.
Long hair, dark skin, infectious smile –
That was the standard for longing for miles.
For months and years, the disease spread
Over two humans that were of dread.
Soft were the beginnings of the hardest battle,
Fulfilling were the ends of the bridge so brittle.
But the disease has cured itself once again,
The connection between the infected severed then.
All it has been, where it had been,
Are in the scars where the point of entry had been.
Can I have that disease again?
Can I be stricken again?

renj

before us

To the ones who came before us,
All the dreams that you had are up
For the night and its distrust.
The silver moon herself could not stop.

The beaches you've waved upon
Have come to their parting time.
The rift between your people has begun,
Your wish is now a heavenly crime.

All you've risked is up to the waves.
What can you understand now?
This was a present the past couldn't save.
When will that regret turn to now?

Broken were you to fix these walls,
Just to coarse over time and become sand.
Those these feet walk over calls,
And whom the cult wraths in bands.

The candles you've melted have burnt,
The crack is starting to show itself.
Will you help us from the other side mount?
Do you hear us pleading for thy help?

Are your eyes real, or are they stones?
Will they smoothen my deadly cry?
Will you dread what this had become?
Did your wisdom really fly?

Our secret language has been uncovered,
The seas were already charted.
The men and their women are in distrust,
Your golden throne has come to rust.

Are the days of these swindle over?
Or is this a chapter that is a must?
Will we be able to truly recover?
This I send to the ones who came before us.

the move of might

renj

A king longed for new jewels for his crown,
Ones that only the Sun could shine down.
The presents came in the form of light,
And to catch it required the move of might.

To have the desired tomorrow is one thing,
But to have it in your hand is another.
Pave your own demise in the guise of the future,
Then the past becomes the present you're longing for.

True might is achieved by will and power.
So the King yielded all he could offer.
The fame of being anonymous he undertook,
And in temptation, his head shook.

For he believed that tomorrow was coming,
And that his fate was like no other.
For he forged his own carpet for the future,
And that light was his to belong to.

And so he climbed over the windy roads,
And lost the soles of his feet, the bands of his hands.
Reached the top with the crown to adorn,
Only to find that the light had been scorned.

For the tomorrow he believed in was not coming.
For men of any class are no other.
Bare was his dignity over this false future.
For everything he wanted was everything he lost.

renj

for that city is ahead

There are cities that exist in the mind,
The ones that you are yet to find.
Where the kids grow to become great,
The elders nourish the young's fate.

Where the fields grow to build anew,
Where the trees grow over the few.
Flesh and bones brush true,
And the eyes therefore truly seek you.

With hands that offer to tell the truth,
Ones that never deviate from the root.
And minds that cannot deny
The meaning that haunts them at night.

For that city is ahead of us in my mind,
Oh, I can take you there from behind.
Kiss the air and it will surely find,
You'll understand why the stars shined.

True and blue the skies appear,
Red and cold the sunsets dear.
To close the window is to open thy heart,
And to create, to challenge the art.

For that ideation of a moment is not true,
If one of them couldn't be you.
A lifetime's worth of dreams and paths,
A man's whole life spent on his wrath.

But all I can do is create these,
All the years I could barely please.
A touch that's worth a lifetime's gold,
And a future that's mine in goal.

For that city is ahead of me.
The capital of the state that shines.
All will be in awe of its glory,
All will live for its memory.

acacia flowers are not forever

renj

Acacia flowers are not forever.
Blooming today, but no pinks tomorrow.
The spindles fall from forever,
A time that was only borrowed.

Dock the scenes over this port,
Bending the waves with the winds.
Their small leaves blending forth,
Streaking over the bland wins.

Yet it remains temporary.
Hundreds of fibers around the gold.
But the non-lasting creates a memory,
One that even the mind cannot hold.

Pump the veins with the aroma,
Clear the leaves with my persona.
Sky-blue reign over these greens,
But one can't deny what has been.

Acacia flowers are not forever.
No seeds form to grow the present.
Dwindling times in the eyes of the lover,
Swirling through the halls of resent.

Reverse the cycle, then it speeds up.
To take care of it is to take its life.
Hold through your eyes its unfolding,
For the delicate spindles are dying.

The gold remains bare over the grass,
The little spark in death.
Once brown, black, and broken like glass,
The beauty was in the death.

But that esque is not obvious to see.
One that the mind concedes to never.
All the spindles run over the wind so free.
Acacia flowers are not forever.

renj **to give a reason**

To hang on a hoax to live,
To hang on a lie to give.
One step closer to the fold,
One step further from the cold.

The fit survive the wild,
The greats produce a child.
Tens and rows of fervor,
To put yours in the favor.

The tree bends off its will,
A dish cooks himself on the grill.
To create the bench is to be cut,
To impact is to blot.

To live on is to permanently lie.
To be revered is to die.
And my sticks are stones,
A story to read when it's all bones.



rivers running *backwards*

untitled (1222) // lines of this clock // the night train ride //
for touching is a sin // true to word and true to man //
before us // the move of might // for that city is ahead //
acacia flowers are not forever // to give a reason



© 2025, Renj. rivers running backwards and all poems contained within are the exclusive intellectual property of the author, Renj. This collection has been made public through Renj Creatives. Unauthorized reproduction, distribution, or use of this collection, in part or in whole is strictly prohibited without prior written permission from the copyright holder.

All rights reserved. For permissions or inquiries, please contact: renjcreatives@gmail.com.